

NOAA ENSO Summary

1. ISSUED BY

CLIMATE PREDICTION CENTER/NCEP/NWS 14 May 2026

2. ENSO ALERT SYSTEM STATUS

El Niño Watch

3. SYNOPSIS

El Niño is likely to emerge soon (82% chance in May-July 2026) and continue through Northern Hemisphere winter 2026-27 (96% chance in December 2026-February 2027). In the past month, ENSO-neutral conditions continued, as indicated by near-average sea surface temperatures (SSTs) in the east-central equatorial Pacific Ocean [Fig. 1].

4. LATEST DATA

The latest weekly Niño-3.4 index value was +0.4°C

5. SST ANOMALIES (FIGURE 01)

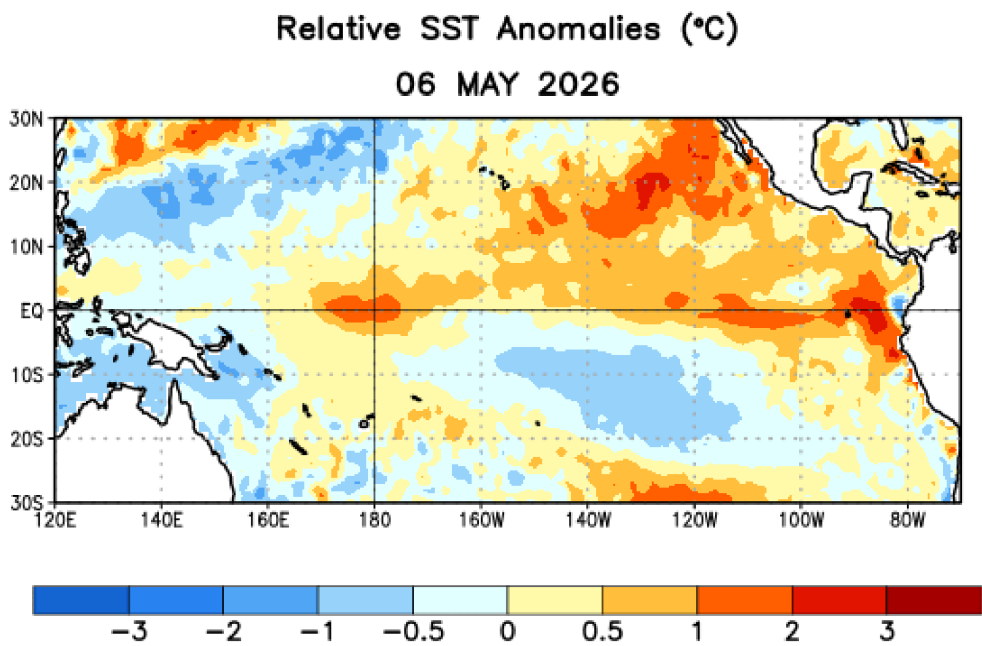


Figure 1. Average relative sea surface temperature (SST) anomalies (°C) for the week centered on 6 May 2026. Anomalies are computed with respect to the 1991-2020 base period weekly means.

6. FORECAST MODEL (FIGURE 06)



NWS/NCEP/CPC

Last update: Mon May 11 2026
Initial conditions: 1May2026–10May2026

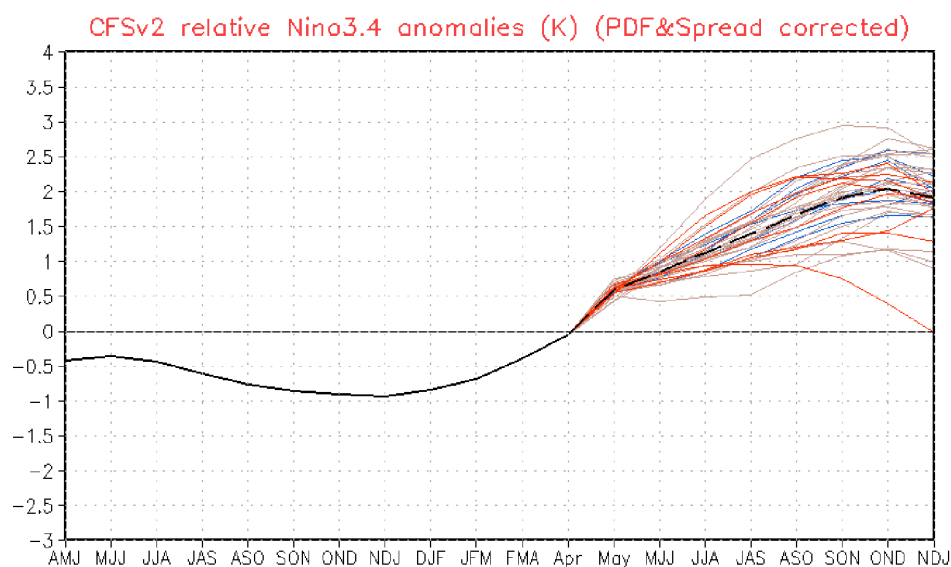


Figure 6. NCEP Climate Forecast System (CFSv2) prediction of relative sea surface temperature anomalies for the Niño 3.4 index (5°N-5°S, 170°W-120°W) minus tropical mean (20°N-20°S). The relative index is re-scaled to match the variance of the traditional index. Figure updated 11 May 2026.